

German Vocabulary

tadellos / tadellose

Definition: Completely without faults, defects, or grounds for criticism; impeccable in quality, behavior, or condition.

Grammar: Adjective. *tadellose* is a declined form of *tadellos*; the ending depends on case, gender, number, and article.

Example: *Sie hat eine tadellose Arbeit geleistet.* — “She did an impeccable job.”

English: impeccable

der Eckpfeiler

Definition: Literally a corner pillar; figuratively, a fundamental element or principle on which something depends.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Eckpfeiler*; plural: *die Eckpfeiler*.

Example: *Vertrauen ist ein Eckpfeiler jeder guten Beziehung.* — “Trust is a cornerstone of every good relationship.”

English: cornerstone

einschüchtern

Definition: To make someone feel afraid, insecure, or less confident, often in order to influence their behavior.

Grammar: Separable weak verb: *einschüchtern* – *schüchterte ein* – *hat eingeschüchtert*. Usually takes an accusative object: *jemanden einschüchtern*.

Example: *Lass dich von ihm nicht einschüchtern.* — “Don’t let him intimidate you.”

English: intimidate

schwinden / schwindet

Definition: To gradually become smaller, weaker, less, or disappear.

Grammar: Strong verb: *schwinden* – *schwand* – *ist geschwunden*. *schwindet* is 3rd-person singular present.

Example: *Seine Hoffnung schwindet langsam.* — “His hope is slowly fading.”

English: fade

verwundbar

Definition: Able to be harmed, injured, attacked, or emotionally hurt; also used for systems or positions susceptible to damage.

Grammar: Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Das System ist verwundbar*) or declined before a noun.

Example: *Ohne Unterstützung ist das System besonders verwundbar.* — “Without support, the system is especially vulnerable.”

English: vulnerable

vereiteln

Definition: To deliberately prevent a plan, attempt, or intended event from succeeding or taking place.

Grammar: Weak, inseparable verb: *vereiteln* – *vereitelte* – *hat vereitelt*. Usually takes an accusative object.

Example: *Die Polizei konnte den Anschlag vereiteln.* — “The police were able to thwart the attack.”

English: thwart

untergraben

Definition: Literally to dig beneath something; figuratively, to gradually weaken authority, stability, trust, or effectiveness.

Grammar: Strong, inseparable verb: *untergraben* – *untergrub* – *hat untergraben*. Takes an accusative object.

Example: *Sein Verhalten untergräbt das Vertrauen im Team.* — “His behavior undermines trust within the team.”

English: undermine

die Umkehrung

Definition: The act or result of reversing, inverting, or turning something into its opposite or reverse order.

Grammar: Feminine noun: *die Umkehrung*; plural: *die Umkehrungen*. Related to *umkehren*.

Example: *Die Umkehrung dieser Entwicklung wäre schwierig.* — “Reversing this development would be difficult.”

English: reversal

erwerben

Definition: To obtain or acquire something such as property, rights, qualifications, knowledge, or a product.

Grammar: Strong verb: *erwerben* – *erwarb* – *hat erworben*. Takes an accusative object: *etwas erwerben*.

Example: *Dieses Zertifikat können Sie online erwerben.* — “You can acquire this certificate online.”

English: acquire

vernachlässigen

Definition: To fail to give a person, thing, responsibility, or area the care, attention, or effort it requires.

Grammar: Weak, inseparable verb: *vernachlässigen* – *vernachlässigte* – *hat vernachlässigt*. Takes an accusative object.

Example: *Er hat seine Gesundheit jahrelang vernachlässigt.* — “He neglected his health for years.”

English: neglect

die Anmaßung

Definition: An unjustified or presumptuous claim to authority, importance, rights, or competence.

Grammar: Feminine noun: *die Anmaßung*; plural: *die Anmaßungen*. Related to *sich etwas anmaßen*.

Example: *Es wäre eine Anmaßung, für alle Menschen sprechen zu wollen.* — “It would be presumptuous to claim to speak for everyone.”

English: presumption

beurteilen / beurteilt

Definition: To form or express a judgment about someone or something on the basis of information, qualities, or criteria.

Grammar: Weak, inseparable verb: *beurteilen* – *beurteilte* – *hat beurteilt*. *beurteilt* can be the past participle or a present-tense form.

Example: *Man sollte andere nicht zu schnell beurteilen.* — “One should not judge others too quickly.”

English: judge

das Äußere / nach seinem Äußeren

Definition: A person's or thing's outward appearance, as opposed to inner qualities or substance.

Grammar: Substantivized adjective: *das Äußere*. In *nach seinem Äußeren*, *nach* governs the dative, so *Äußeren* is dative singular.

Example: *Man sollte einen Menschen nicht nur nach seinem Äußeren beurteilen.* — “One should not judge a person solely by their appearance.”

English: appearance

eingeschüchtert

Definition: Feeling afraid, insecure, or lacking in confidence because of another person, situation, or perceived threat.

Grammar: Past participle of *einschüchtern*, often used adjectivally or predicatively: *sich eingeschüchtert fühlen*.

Example: *Ich fühle mich von meinem neuen Chef eingeschüchtert.* — “I feel intimidated by my new boss.”

English: intimidated

erringen / errungen

Definition: To achieve, win, or obtain something through considerable effort, struggle, or persistence. Commonly used with victories, successes, titles, and achievements.

Grammar: Strong verb: *erringen* – *errang* – *hat errungen*. *errungen* is the past participle and the verb usually takes an accusative object.

Example: *Die Mannschaft hat einen wichtigen Sieg errungen.* — “The team achieved an important victory.”

English: win

der Zorn

Definition: A strong feeling of anger, generally more intense and elevated in tone than everyday *Ärger*. It can sound literary or solemn.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Zorn*. It is normally used in the singular and has no common plural in ordinary usage. **Example:** *Er konnte seinen Zorn kaum verbergen.* — “He could hardly hide his anger.”

English: wrath

zukommen / jemandem kommt eine Funktion zu

Definition: In this formal construction, *zukommen* means that something has, assumes, or is assigned a particular function, significance, or role.

Grammar: Separable verb: *zukommen* – *kam zu* – *ist zugekommen*. In *Argumenten kommt eine Funktion zu*, *Argumenten* is dative while *eine Funktion* is nominative.

Example: *Der Sprache kommt dabei eine wichtige Funktion zu.* — “Language serves an important function in this context.”

English: serve

entscheidend

Definition: Extremely important in determining an outcome or development; decisive or crucial.

Grammar: Adjective. Its ending changes according to gender, number, case, and determiner: *eine entscheidende Funktion, ein entscheidender Moment.*

Example: *Vertrauen spielt dabei eine entscheidende Rolle.* — “Trust plays a crucial role in this.”

English: crucial

ablenken

Definition: To divert someone’s attention away from something, especially from the real issue, problem, or activity.

Grammar: Separable weak verb: *ablenken – lenkte ab – hat abgelenkt.* Common construction: *jemanden von etwas ablenken.*

Example: *Er versuchte, mich von der eigentlichen Frage abzulenken.* — “He tried to distract me from the real question.”

English: distract

die Spur / Spuren verbergen

Definition: A *Spur* is a trace, track, clue, or sign left behind. *Seine Spuren verbergen* means to conceal evidence of one’s actions, similar to “cover one’s tracks.”

Grammar: Feminine noun: *die Spur*; plural: *die Spuren.* *verbergen* is strong: *verbergen – verbarg – hat verborgen.*

Example: *Er versuchte, seine Spuren zu verbergen.* — “He tried to cover his tracks.”

English: trace

die List

Definition: A clever but deceptive plan or method used to achieve something by misleading another person. It is more literary or formal than *Trick*.

Grammar: Feminine noun: *die List*; plural: *die Listen.* Do not confuse it with *die Liste*, which means “list.”

Example: *Mit einer List gelang es ihm, seine Gegner zu täuschen.* — “Through a ruse, he managed to deceive his opponents.”

English: ruse

ertappen

Definition: To catch or discover someone in the act of doing something wrong, dishonest, or intended to remain hidden.

Grammar: Weak verb: *ertappen – ertappte – hat ertappt.* Common construction: *jemanden bei etwas ertappen.*

Example: *Sie wurde beim Lügen ertappt.* — “She was caught lying.”

English: catch

der Hochstapler / Hochstaplern

Definition: A person who deceives others by pretending to possess a higher status, qualifications, wealth, expertise, or identity than they actually have.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Hochstapler*; plural: *die Hochstapler*. *Hochstaplern* is dative plural, e.g. *von Hochstaplern*.

Example: *Er ließ sich von den Hochstaplern täuschen.* — “He was deceived by the impostors.”

English: impostor

der Schwindler

Definition: Someone who deceives or cheats other people through lies, tricks, or fraudulent claims. It is broader in meaning than *Hochstapler*.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Schwindler*; plural: *die Schwindler*. Feminine form: *die Schwindlerin*.

Example: *Er entpuppte sich als geschickter Schwindler.* — “He turned out to be a skilled fraudster.”

English: fraudster

der Tölpel / Tölpeln

Definition: A clumsy, foolish, socially awkward, or unsophisticated person. The word is derogatory and can have an old-fashioned or literary flavor.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Tölpel*; plural: *die Tölpel*. *Tölpeln* is dative plural, e.g. *mit diesen Tölpeln*.

Example: *Er wollte sich nicht mit diesen Tölpeln abgeben.* — “He didn’t want to associate with these oafs.”

English: oaf

der Kasten

Definition: A box, case, crate, or other usually rectangular container. It can also refer to a crate of drinks or, colloquially, a bulky rectangular object.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Kasten*; plural: *die Kästen*. This is distinct from *die Kaste* → *die Kasten*, meaning “caste/castes.”

Example: *Im Keller steht noch ein Kasten Bier.* — “There’s still a crate of beer in the basement.”

English: box

jemanden ausfindig machen

Definition: To find or locate someone after searching for them, often implying that the person was difficult to find or that some investigation was necessary.

Grammar: Fixed expression: *jemanden/etwas ausfindig machen*. The person or thing being located is in the accusative. Conjugation follows *machen*: *macht ausfindig* – *machte ausfindig* – *hat ausfindig gemacht*.

Example: *Die Polizei konnte den Verdächtigen schließlich ausfindig machen.* — “The police were finally able to locate the suspect.”

English: locate

das Klopfen / ein Klopfen

Definition: A knocking or tapping sound, usually produced by striking a surface such as a door, wall, or window. It can also describe a pounding sensation.

Grammar: Neuter noun derived from the verb *klopfen*: *das Klopfen*. *Ein Klopfen* can be nominative or

accusative singular depending on the sentence.

Example: *Plötzlich hörte sie ein Klopfen an der Tür.* — “Suddenly she heard a knock at the door.”

English: knocking

der Gewehrlauf

Definition: The long metal tube of a rifle or firearm through which the projectile travels when the weapon is fired.

Grammar: Masculine compound noun: *der Gewehrlauf*; plural: *die Gewehrläufe*. Formed from *Gewehr* + *Lauf*.

Example: *Der Gewehrlauf war auf den Boden gerichtet.* — “The rifle barrel was pointed at the ground.”

English: barrel

ausschließen / ausgeschlossen

Definition: To exclude, rule out, or prevent something from being considered or possible. *Ausgeschlossen* can also mean “out of the question” or “impossible.”

Grammar: Strong separable verb: *ausschließen* – *schloss aus* – *hat ausgeschlossen*. *Ausgeschlossen* is the past participle and can also be used adjectivally.

Example: *Ein technischer Fehler kann nicht ausgeschlossen werden.* — “A technical error cannot be ruled out.”

English: exclude

bedienen / bedient

Definition: To serve a person, especially a customer, or to operate/use a machine or device. The exact meaning depends strongly on context.

Grammar: Weak verb: *bedienen* – *bediente* – *hat bedient*. *Bedient* can be the past participle or a present-tense form: *er bedient* / *ihr bedient*.

Example: *Der Kellner hat die Gäste schnell bedient.* — “The waiter served the guests quickly.”

English: serve

sich senken / senkte sich nach und nach

Definition: To gradually move downward, become lower, or descend. *Nach und nach* emphasizes that the change happens little by little rather than suddenly.

Grammar: Reflexive weak verb: *sich senken* – *senkte sich* – *hat sich gesenkt*. *Nach und nach* is an adverbial expression meaning “gradually.”

Example: *Der Nebel senkte sich nach und nach über das Tal.* — “The fog gradually descended over the valley.”

English: descend

überschütten / überschüttet

Definition: Literally, to pour or shower something over someone or something. Figuratively, it often means to overwhelm someone with praise, criticism, gifts, questions, or similar things.

Grammar: Weak inseparable verb: *überschütten* – *überschüttete* – *hat überschüttet*. Common construction: *jemanden mit etwas überschütten*.

Example: *Nach dem Erfolg wurde sie mit Glückwünschen überschüttet.* — “After the success, she was showered with congratulations.”

English: shower

die Anleitung

Definition: Instructions or guidance explaining how to do, use, assemble, or operate something. Depending on context, it can mean a manual, set of instructions, or guidance.

Grammar: Feminine noun: *die Anleitung*; plural: *die Anleitungen*. Common construction: *eine Anleitung für etwas*.

Example: *Bitte lesen Sie zuerst die Anleitung.* — “Please read the instructions first.”

English: instructions

zögernd

Definition: Acting with hesitation or uncertainty; not immediately willing, confident, or decisive.

Grammar: Present participle/adjectival form of *zögern* (“to hesitate”). It can be used adjectivally or adverbially: *eine zögernde Antwort* / *zögernd antworten*.

Example: *Er öffnete zögernd die Tür.* — “He hesitantly opened the door.”

English: hesitantly

belästigen

Definition: To bother, disturb, annoy, or harass someone, especially in an intrusive or repeated way.

Grammar: Weak verb: *belästigen* – *belästigte* – *hat belästigt*. Usually takes an accusative object: *jemanden belästigen*.

Example: *Bitte belästigen Sie die anderen Gäste nicht.* — “Please do not bother the other guests.”

English: harass

allmählich

Definition: Happening slowly and progressively over time, rather than suddenly; little by little. **Grammar:** Adverb. It describes a gradual change or development over time.

Example: *Sein Vertrauen schwand allmählich.* — “His trust gradually faded.”

English: gradually

verdächtig

Definition: Making someone seem suspicious or likely to be involved in wrongdoing, or giving the impression that something is questionable, dishonest, or dangerous. It can describe a person, behavior, object, or situation. **Grammar:** Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Er wirkt verdächtig*) or declined before a noun: *ein verdächtiger Mann*, *eine verdächtige Situation*. It is often used in police, legal, and everyday contexts. **Example:** *Die Polizei hielt den Mann wegen seines verdächtigen Verhaltens an.* — “The police stopped the man because of his suspicious behavior.” **English:** suspicious / suspect / dubious

Strich

Definition: A line, stroke, mark, or strip; also used figuratively for a small amount, a trace, or a single act of crossing out or making a mark. In context, it can also mean a streak, a slash, or a short line segment.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Strich*; plural: *die Striche*. It appears in expressions such as *ein Strich durch die Rechnung* ("a spanner in the works"), *den Strich ziehen* ("to draw the line / to set a limit"), and *eine Linie ziehen* in some contexts. The exact meaning depends heavily on context. **Example:** *Ein Strich durch die Rechnung! Jetzt müssen wir alles neu planen.* — "A spanner in the works! Now we have to plan everything again." **English:** line / stroke / mark / streak

einstufen (als)

Definition: To classify, categorize, rate, or assess someone or something by assigning them to a particular category, level, group, or degree of importance or risk. **Grammar:** Separable weak verb: *einstufen* – *stufte ein* – *hat eingestuft*. Common constructions: *jemanden/etwas als etwas einstufen* and *jemanden/etwas in eine Kategorie einstufen*. **Example:** *Die Behörden stuften die Situation als gefährlich ein.* — "The authorities classified the situation as dangerous." **English:** classify

schändlich

Definition: Morally disgraceful, shameful, or dishonorable; describing an action or behavior that deserves strong condemnation. It has a somewhat elevated or literary tone. **Grammar:** Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Das war schändlich*) or declined before a noun: *eine schändliche Tat*. **Example:** *Er wurde für sein schändliches Verhalten scharf kritisiert.* — "He was harshly criticized for his disgraceful behavior." **English:** disgraceful

die Wohltätigkeit

Definition: The act or practice of helping people in need, especially through donations, financial support, or organized charitable work. It can also refer more generally to charitable activity or benevolence. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Wohltätigkeit*. It is usually used in the singular. The related adjective is *wohl tätig* ("charitable"). **Example:** *Sie engagiert sich seit Jahren für wohltätige Zwecke.* — "She has been involved in charitable causes for years." **English:** charity

einen Schritt voraus

Synonym: im Vorteil / voraus **Definition:** To be in a more advanced, informed, or advantageous position than someone else, often because you have anticipated what will happen next. **Grammar:** Idiomatic expression, usually used with *sein*: *jemandem einen Schritt voraus sein*. The person being surpassed is in the dative. **Example:** *Sie ist ihren Konkurrenten immer einen Schritt voraus.* — "She is always one step ahead of her competitors." **English:** one step ahead · **French:** avoir une longueur d'avance

Leibwache

Synonym: Personenschutz / Schutztruppe **Definition:** A group of guards responsible for protecting an important, powerful, or endangered person from attack or other threats. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Leibwache*; plural: *die Leibwachen*. Often used collectively for a person's bodyguards. **Example:** *Der Präsident wurde von seiner Leibwache zum Fahrzeug begleitet.* — "The president was escorted to the vehicle by his bodyguards." **English:** bodyguard / security detail · **French:** garde du corps

versorgen

Synonym: **beliefern / betreuen / sich kümmern um** **Definition:** To provide a person, group, or place with something they need, such as food, energy, information, or medical care. It can also mean to look after or care for someone. **Grammar:** Weak, inseparable verb: *versorgen – versorgte – hat versorgt*. Common construction: *jemanden mit etwas versorgen* ("to provide someone with something"), where *jemanden* is accusative and *mit etwas* takes the dative. **Example:** *Das Krankenhaus versorgt die Patienten mit Medikamenten.* — "The hospital provides the patients with medication." **English:** **provide / supply / care for** · **French:** **fournir / approvisionner / soigner**

gewaltig

Synonym: **enormous / tremendous / mighty** **Definition:** Very large, powerful, intense, or impressive in size, force, extent, or effect. Depending on context, it can describe physical magnitude, strength, impact, or degree. **Grammar:** Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Der Unterschied ist gewaltig*) or declined before a noun (*eine gewaltige Kraft*). **Example:** *Der Sturm richtete gewaltige Schäden an.* — "The storm caused tremendous damage." **English:** **enormous / tremendous** · **French:** **énorme / formidable**

Rückzug

Definition: A retreat, withdrawal, or pulling back from a position, conflict, responsibility, or public engagement. It can refer to a physical retreat, a strategic withdrawal, or a gradual disengagement from a situation. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Rückzug*; plural: *die Rückzüge*. It is often used in military, political, personal, or strategic contexts, e.g. *einen Rückzug vorbereiten* ("to prepare a withdrawal"). **Example:** *Nach dem Streit zog er sich in einen stillen Rückzug zurück.* — "After the argument, he withdrew into a quiet retreat." **English:** **retreat / withdrawal**

sich verhelpfen

Synonym: **sich verschaffen / erreichen** **Definition:** To help oneself obtain or achieve something. More commonly, German uses *jemandem zu etwas verhelpfen* for "to help someone attain something." **Grammar:** *verhelpfen* is a strong, inseparable verb: *verhelpfen – verhalf – hat verhelpfen*. Standard construction: *jemandem zu etwas verhelpfen*, with the person in the dative and *zu* + dative for the thing achieved. Reflexive *sich verhelpfen* is possible only in limited contexts and is less idiomatic. **Example:** *Der neue Job verhalf ihm zu finanzieller Unabhängigkeit.* — "The new job helped him achieve financial independence." **English:** **help attain / enable to achieve** · **French:** **aider à obtenir / permettre d'atteindre**

täuschen

Synonym: **irreführen / betrügen / einen falschen Eindruck vermitteln** **Definition:** To make someone believe something that is false or misleading, either deliberately or because appearances create a wrong impression. Reflexively, *sich täuschen* means to be mistaken. **Grammar:** Weak verb: *täuschen – täuschte – hat getäuscht*. Common constructions: *jemanden täuschen*; *sich in jemandem/etwas täuschen*; *sich bei etwas täuschen*. **Example:** *Der Betrüger versuchte, die Kunden mit gefälschten Unterlagen zu täuschen.* — "The fraudster tried to deceive the customers with forged documents." **English:** **deceive / mislead** · **French:** **tromper / induire en erreur**

Ermittlern

Synonym: Untersuchungsbeamten / Fahndern Definition: People who investigate a crime, suspicious event, or other matter in order to establish what happened and identify those responsible. **Grammar:** Dative plural of *der Ermittler*; plural: *die Ermittler*. In *den Ermittlern*, the dative plural normally takes the additional **-n**: *den Ermittlern*. **Example:** *Nach tagelanger Suche gelang es den Ermittlern, den Zeugen ausfindig zu machen.* — “After days of searching, the investigators managed to locate the witness.” **English:** **investigators / detectives** · **French:** **enquêteurs / investigateurs**

überlegen

Synonym: besser / stärker / im Vorteil Definition: Better, stronger, more capable, or in a more advantageous position than someone or something else. **Grammar:** Adjective. Very commonly used with the dative: *jemandem überlegen sein*. **Example:** *Sie war ihren Konkurrenten strategisch überlegen.* — “She was strategically superior to her competitors.” **English:** **superior / better** · **French:** **supérieur / avantage**

die Feindseligkeit

Synonym: Feindschaft / Ablehnung / feindliche Haltung Definition: A hostile, unfriendly, or antagonistic attitude or behavior toward another person, group, or idea. It can refer either to a general feeling of hostility or to specific hostile actions or remarks. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Feindseligkeit*; plural: *die Feindseligkeiten*. The plural often refers to hostile acts or open conflict between opposing sides. **Example:** *Zwischen den beiden Gruppen herrschte offene Feindseligkeit.* — “There was open hostility between the two groups.” **English:** **hostility / animosity** · **French:** **hostilité / animosité**

verabscheuen

Synonym: hassen / zutiefst ablehnen / abscheulich finden Definition: To feel very strong dislike, disgust, or moral rejection toward someone or something. It is stronger and often more emphatic than *nicht mögen* and can express both hatred and deep aversion. **Grammar:** Weak, inseparable verb: *verabscheuen – verabscheute – hat verabscheut*. Usually takes an accusative object: *jemanden/etwas verabscheuen*. **Example:** *Sie verabscheut jede Form von Gewalt.* — “She detests every form of violence.” **English:** **detest / loathe / abhor** · **French:** **détester / abhorrer**

das Leid

Synonym: Kummer / Schmerz / Qual / Elend Definition: Physical or emotional suffering, pain, sorrow, or distress. Compared with *Elend*, *Leid* is broader and often refers more directly to the experience of suffering itself rather than to a miserable condition or severe poverty. **Grammar:** Neuter noun: *das Leid*. Usually used in the singular. Common expressions include *jemandem Leid zufügen* (“to cause someone suffering”), *Leid erfahren* (“to experience suffering”), and *es tut mir leid* (“I’m sorry”), although the last expression has developed an idiomatic meaning. **Example:** *Der Krieg brachte der Bevölkerung großes Leid.* — “The war brought great suffering to the population.” **English:** **suffering / sorrow / pain / grief** · **French:** **souffrance / peine / douleur / chagrin**

das Elend

Synonym: Not / Jammer / großes Leid Definition: A state of severe suffering, misery, hardship, or poverty. It can describe both material deprivation and intense emotional or human suffering. **Grammar:** Neuter noun: *das Elend*. It is usually used in the singular and has no common plural in standard usage.

Example: *Viele Menschen lebten nach dem Krieg in großem Elend.* — “Many people lived in great misery after the war.” **English:** misery / destitution / suffering · **French:** misère / détresse

abgenutzt

Synonym: verschlissen / gebraucht / abgetragen **Definition:** Worn down, damaged, or showing signs of heavy use over time. It can describe objects, clothes, surfaces, or figuratively an expression or idea that has become stale through overuse. **Grammar:** Past participle of *abnutzen*, often used adjectivally. Verb: *abnutzen* – *nutzte ab* – *hat abgenutzt*. Reflexive use is also common: *sich abnutzen*. **Example:** *Der Teppich ist an den Rändern stark abgenutzt.* — “The carpet is badly worn at the edges.” **English:** worn / worn out / threadbare · **French:** usé / élimé

die Geistesgegenwart

Synonym: Besonnenheit / Reaktionsschnelligkeit / Umsicht **Definition:** The ability to remain mentally alert, calm, and capable of reacting quickly and appropriately in a sudden, difficult, or dangerous situation. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Geistesgegenwart*. It is generally used in the singular. Common expression: *Geistesgegenwart beweisen / zeigen*. **Example:** *Dank ihrer Geistesgegenwart konnte sie Schlimmeres verhindern.* — “Thanks to her presence of mind, she was able to prevent something worse.” **English:** presence of mind / quick-wittedness · **French:** présence d’esprit / sang-froid

widrig

Synonym: ungünstig / hinderlich / nachteilig / schwierig **Definition:** Unfavorable, adverse, or obstructive; used for circumstances, conditions, or situations that make something more difficult or work against a desired outcome. It is especially common in the expression *widrige Umstände*. **Grammar:** Adjective. Often used attributively: *widrige Umstände*, *widrige Bedingungen*. The declined ending changes according to case, gender, number, and article. **Example:** *Trotz widriger Umstände setzte sie ihre Arbeit fort.* — “Despite adverse circumstances, she continued her work.” **English:** adverse / unfavorable · **French:** défavorable / adverse

der Aufruhr

Synonym: Unruhe / Tumult / Aufstand / Unruhen **Definition:** A state of intense public disturbance, disorder, or agitation, often involving a crowd, protest, rebellion, or violent unrest. It can also be used figuratively for great emotional or social turmoil. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Aufruhr*. It is usually used in the singular. Common expressions: *in Aufruhr geraten*, *für Aufruhr sorgen*. **Example:** *Die umstrittene Entscheidung versetzte die Bevölkerung in Aufruhr.* — “The controversial decision threw the population into uproar.” **English:** uproar / unrest / turmoil · **French:** agitation / troubles / tumulte

unmittelbar

Synonym: direkt / sofort / unmittelbar folgend **Definition:** Directly, immediately, or without anything intervening in space, time, or connection. Depending on context, it can mean “right next to,” “straight after,” or “directly connected.” **Grammar:** Adjective or adverb. As an adjective, it is declined: *die unmittelbare Nähe*, *ein unmittelbarer Zusammenhang*. As an adverb, it remains unchanged: *unmittelbar danach*. **Example:** *Das Hotel liegt unmittelbar am Bahnhof.* — “The hotel is located directly next to the train station.” **English:** immediate / direct / directly · **French:** immédiat / direct / directement

gerecht

Synonym: fair / angemessen / rechtmäßig **Definition:** Fair, just, or appropriate according to moral principles, rules, or what someone deserves. Depending on context, it can describe a person, decision, treatment, distribution, or outcome. **Grammar:** Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Das ist gerecht*) or declined before a noun: *eine gerechte Entscheidung, ein gerechter Lohn*. **Example:** *Alle Mitarbeiter sollten gerecht behandelt werden.* — “All employees should be treated fairly.” **English:** fair / just / equitable · **French:** juste / équitable

beharren

Synonym: bestehen auf / festhalten an / nicht nachgeben **Definition:** To continue firmly insisting on an opinion, demand, position, or course of action and refuse to change it, even when others disagree or apply pressure. **Grammar:** Inseparable weak verb: *beharren – beharrte – hat beharrt*. Most commonly used with **auf + dative:** *auf etwas beharren* (“to insist on something”). **Example:** *Sie beharrte auf ihrer ursprünglichen Entscheidung.* — “She insisted on her original decision.” **English:** insist / persist / stand firm · **French:** insister / persister / maintenir

der Gipfel

Definition: The highest point or summit of a mountain. Figuratively, it can also refer to the highest point, peak, or culmination of an achievement, development, or period. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Gipfel*; plural: *die Gipfel*. Common expressions include *den Gipfel erreichen* (“to reach the summit”) and *auf dem Gipfel stehen* (“to stand at the summit”). **Example:** *Nach mehreren Stunden erreichten die Bergsteiger endlich den Gipfel.* — “After several hours, the climbers finally reached the summit.” **English:** summit / peak · **French:** sommet

erklimmen

Definition: To climb or ascend something, especially a mountain, summit, steep path, or height. It often suggests reaching a high point through physical effort and is somewhat more elevated in style than simply *steigen*. **Grammar:** Weak verb: *erklimmen – erklomm*? No: standard conjugation is *erklimmen – erklomm – hat erklommen*. It takes an accusative object: *einen Berg / einen Gipfel erklimmen*. **Example:** *Sie wollten den höchsten Gipfel der Region erklimmen.* — “They wanted to climb the highest peak in the region.” **English:** climb / scale / ascend · **French:** gravir / escalader

der Neid

Definition: A feeling of resentment or dissatisfaction caused by wanting something that another person has, such as success, possessions, abilities, or advantages. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Neid*. It is usually used in the singular. Common expressions include *Neid auf jemanden haben* (“to be envious of someone”) and *vor Neid erblassen* (“to turn pale with envy”). **Example:** *Er betrachtete den Erfolg seines Kollegen mit unverhohlenem Neid.* — “He looked at his colleague’s success with undisguised envy.” **English:** envy / jealousy · **French:** envie / jalousie

töricht

Definition: Foolish, unwise, or lacking good judgment; describing a decision, action, or person that shows poor sense. **Grammar:** Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Das war töricht*) or declined before a noun:

eine törichte Entscheidung. **Example:** *Es wäre töricht, diese Warnung einfach zu ignorieren.* — “It would be foolish to simply ignore this warning.” **English:** foolish / unwise · **French:** insensé / imprudent / sot

der Rang

Definition: A position or level within a hierarchy, organization, profession, or social structure. It can also refer more generally to status, standing, or importance. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Rang*; plural: *die Ränge*. Common expressions include *einen hohen Rang haben* (“to hold a high rank”), *im Rang über jemandem stehen* (“to outrank someone”), and *von hohem Rang sein* (“to be of high importance”). **Example:** *Er bekleidete einen hohen Rang innerhalb der Organisation.* — “He held a high rank within the organization.” **English:** rank / status / standing · **French:** rang / statut / position

sich brüsten

Definition: To boast, brag, or speak proudly about one’s achievements, possessions, qualities, or connections, often in a way that seems self-important or excessive. **Grammar:** Reflexive verb: *sich brüsten* – *brüstete sich* – *hat sich gebrüstet*. Common construction: *sich mit etwas brüsten*, where *mit* takes the dative. **Example:** *Er brüstete sich mit seinen beruflichen Erfolgen.* — “He boasted about his professional achievements.” **English:** boast / brag · **French:** se vanter / se targuer

die Zuneigung

Definition: A warm feeling of affection, fondness, or emotional attachment toward another person, animal, or sometimes a place or thing. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Zuneigung*. Usually used in the singular. Common expressions include *Zuneigung zu jemandem empfinden* (“to feel affection for someone”) and *jemandem Zuneigung zeigen* (“to show someone affection”). **Example:** *Mit der Zeit entwickelte sie eine tiefe Zuneigung zu ihm.* — “Over time, she developed a deep affection for him.” **English:** affection / fondness · **French:** affection / tendresse

erschreckend

Synonym: beunruhigend / alarmierend / schockierend **Definition:** Causing fear, shock, concern, or alarm; describing something that is disturbing or frightening because of its seriousness or intensity. **Grammar:** Present participle/adjectival form of *erschrecken*. It can be used predicatively (*Das ist erschreckend*) or declined before a noun (*eine erschreckende Entwicklung*). **Example:** *Die Zahl der Unfälle ist erschreckend hoch.* — “The number of accidents is alarmingly high.” **English:** alarming / frightening / shocking · **French:** alarmant / effrayant / inquiétant

übertrumpfen

Synonym: übertreffen / überbieten / in den Schatten stellen **Definition:** To surpass or outdo someone, especially by performing better, achieving more, or presenting something even more impressive. Originally, it also refers to beating a card by playing a trump card. **Grammar:** Weak verb: *übertrumpfen* – *übertrumpfte* – *hat übertrumpft*. Usually takes an accusative object: *jemanden/etwas übertrumpfen*. Common expression: *sich gegenseitig übertrumpfen* (“to try to outdo one another”). **Example:** *Die beiden Konkurrenten versuchten ständig, sich gegenseitig zu übertrumpfen.* — “The two competitors constantly tried to outdo each other.” **English:** outdo / surpass / trump · **French:** surpasser / surclasser

der Konkurrent

Synonym: *Rivale / Mitbewerber / Wettbewerber* **Definition:** A person, company, team, or organization that competes with another for the same goal, customers, position, prize, or advantage. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Konkurrent*; feminine: *die Konkurrentin*; plural: *die Konkurrenten / die Konkurrentinnen*. It is a weak masculine noun: *mit dem Konkurrenten, gegen den Konkurrenten*. **Example:** *Das Unternehmen versucht, seinen größten Konkurrenten auf dem Markt zu übertrumpfen.* — “The company is trying to outdo its biggest competitor in the market.” **English:** *competitor / rival* · **French:** *concurrent / rival*

sich wappnen

Definition: To prepare oneself mentally or practically for something difficult, unpleasant, dangerous, or challenging; to arm oneself in anticipation of a test or hardship. **Grammar:** Reflexive verb: *sich wappnen – wappnete sich – hat sich gewappnet*. Common constructions include *sich gegen etwas wappnen* (“to arm oneself against something”) and *sich auf etwas wappnen* (“to prepare oneself for something”). **Example:** *Wir müssen uns gegen Kritik wappnen.* — “We have to prepare ourselves for criticism.” **English:** *brace oneself / prepare oneself / arm oneself*

verfügen

Synonym: *besitzen / haben / anordnen* depending on context **Definition:** To have something at one's disposal, possess or command a resource, ability, or amount. In formal contexts, it can also mean to order or decree something. **Grammar:** Weak, inseparable verb: *verfügen – verfügte – hat verfügt*. Very common construction: *über etwas verfügen* (“to have something at one's disposal / possess”), where *über* takes the accusative. **Example:** *Das Unternehmen verfügt über umfangreiche finanzielle Mittel.* — “The company has substantial financial resources at its disposal.” **English:** *have at one's disposal / possess / command* · **French:** *disposer de / posséder*

vollziehen

Synonym: *durchführen / ausführen / verwirklichen* **Definition:** To carry out, perform, or execute an action, process, decision, or formal procedure. Reflexively, *sich vollziehen* means that a process, change, or event takes place or unfolds. **Grammar:** Strong, inseparable verb: *vollziehen – vollzog – hat vollzogen*. Usually takes an accusative object: *etwas vollziehen*. Reflexive construction: *sich vollziehen* (“to take place / unfold”). **Example:** *Der Wandel vollzog sich über mehrere Jahrzehnte.* — “The change took place over several decades.” **English:** *carry out / execute / take place* · **French:** *accomplir / exécuter / s'accomplir*

verzerren

Synonym: *entstellen / verfälschen / verformen* **Definition:** To distort, deform, or misrepresent something so that its original shape, sound, appearance, meaning, or effect is altered. It can be used both literally, for physical or acoustic distortion, and figuratively, for presenting facts or reality inaccurately. **Grammar:** Weak, inseparable verb: *verzerren – verzerrte – hat verzerrt*. Usually takes an accusative object: *etwas verzerren*. **Example:** *Die Aufnahme verzerrt seine Stimme stark.* — “The recording distorts his voice considerably.” **English:** *distort / warp / misrepresent* · **French:** *déformer / fausser*

unbarmherzig

Synonym: gnadenlos / erbarmungslos / mitleidlos **Definition:** Showing no mercy, compassion, or pity; harsh and relentless toward someone or something. It can describe a person, behavior, punishment, criticism, or difficult conditions. **Grammar:** Adjective/adverb. It can be used predicatively (*Er ist unbarmherzig*), attributively (*eine unbarmherzige Strafe*), or adverbially (*jemanden unbarmherzig bestrafen*). **Example:** *Der Herrscher ging unbarmherzig gegen seine Gegner vor.* — “The ruler dealt mercilessly with his opponents.” **English:** merciless / ruthless / relentless · **French:** impitoyable / sans pitié

Lob

Definition: Praise or approval expressed toward someone for something they have done well, achieved, or possessed. It can be spoken, written, or given in a nonverbal way and is often associated with recognition, respect, or encouragement. **Grammar:** Neuter noun: *das Lob*; no common plural in ordinary usage. It is usually used in the singular and often appears in expressions such as *Lob verdienen* (“to deserve praise”), *jemandem Lob spenden* (“to bestow praise on someone”), and *viel Lob bekommen* (“to get a lot of praise”). **Example:** *Seine Arbeit wurde mit großem Lob gewürdigt.* — “His work was highly praised.” **English:** praise / acclaim

beseitigen

Synonym: entfernen / abschaffen / aus dem Weg räumen **Definition:** To remove, eliminate, or get rid of something unwanted, problematic, or obstructive. Depending on context, it can refer to removing a physical object, solving a problem, eliminating a danger, or abolishing a condition. **Grammar:** Weak, inseparable verb: *beseitigen* – *beseitigte* – *hat beseitigt*. Usually takes an accusative object: *etwas beseitigen*. **Example:** *Die Techniker konnten den Fehler schnell beseitigen.* — “The technicians were able to eliminate the problem quickly.” **English:** remove / eliminate / get rid of · **French:** éliminer / enlever / supprimer

die Verwirrung

Synonym: Unklarheit / Durcheinander / Irritation **Definition:** A state of not understanding something clearly, being uncertain about what is happening, or being mentally disoriented. It can also refer to a confusing situation or disorder. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Verwirrung*; plural: *die Verwirrungen*. Related verb: *verwirren* (“to confuse”). **Example:** *Die widersprüchlichen Informationen sorgten für große Verwirrung.* — “The contradictory information caused great confusion.” **English:** confusion / bewildered · **French:** confusion / désarroi

gerissen

Synonym: schlau / raffiniert / durchtrieben **Definition:** Very clever and skillful at achieving one’s aims, often by using cunning, manipulation, or tricks. Depending on context, it can be admiring (“shrewd”) or negative (“sly”). **Grammar:** Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Er ist gerissen*) or attributively (*ein gerissener Geschäftsmann*). **Example:** *Der gerissene Händler wusste genau, wie er den Preis in die Höhe treiben konnte.* — “The shrewd merchant knew exactly how to drive up the price.” **English:** shrewd / crafty / sly · **French:** rusé / malin / astucieux

hinterlistig

Synonym: heimtückisch / verschlagen / tückisch **Definition:** Deceptive and malicious in a concealed way; describing someone who acts secretly or dishonestly in order to harm, trick, or betray another person. **Grammar:** Adjective/adverb. It can be used predicatively (*Er ist hinterlistig*), attributively (*ein hinterlistiger Plan*), or adverbially (*jemanden hinterlistig täuschen*). **Example:** *Er lockte seinen Gegner mit einem hinterlistigen Trick in die Falle.* — “He lured his opponent into the trap with a treacherous trick.” **English:** treacherous / deceitful / underhanded · **French:** sournois / perfide / traître

gegenüber

Synonym: im Verhältnis zu / im Vergleich zu / auf der anderen Seite von **Definition:** A very common word with several uses. As a preposition, it can mean “toward,” “in relation to,” or “compared with” someone or something. As an adverb, it can mean “opposite” or “across from.” **Grammar:** Usually takes the **dative**: *jemandem gegenüber*. It can come before or after the noun/pronoun: *gegenüber dem Haus / dem Haus gegenüber*. With people, *jemandem gegenüber* often means “toward someone” in the sense of attitude or behavior. **Example:** *Er verhielt sich seinen Kollegen gegenüber sehr freundlich.* — “He behaved very kindly toward his colleagues.” **English:** toward / opposite / compared with / in relation to · **French:** envers / en face de / par rapport à

derartig

Synonym: solch / so beschaffen / von dieser Art **Definition:** Of such a kind or nature; used to refer to something of the type just mentioned or implied. It often emphasizes that something is remarkable, extreme, or characteristic in a particular way. **Grammar:** Adjective/determiner. It is declined like an adjective: *ein derartiger Vorfall, eine derartige Reaktion, derartige Probleme*. **Example:** *Mit einer derartigen Reaktion hatte niemand gerechnet.* — “No one had expected such a reaction.” **English:** such / of that kind / such a · **French:** tel / de ce genre

die Willkür

Synonym: Beliebigkeit / Eigenmächtigkeit / Laune **Definition:** The exercise of power or decision-making according to personal wishes rather than clear rules, laws, fairness, or objective reasons. It usually has a strongly negative meaning. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Willkür*. Usually used in the singular. Common expressions include *staatliche Willkür, der Willkür ausgeliefert sein*, and *willkürlich handeln*. **Example:** *Die Bürger waren der Willkür des Herrschers ausgeliefert.* — “The citizens were at the mercy of the ruler’s arbitrary power.” **English:** arbitrariness / arbitrary exercise of power · **French:** arbitraire

die Launenhaftigkeit

Synonym: Unbeständigkeit / Wechselhaftigkeit / Sprunghaftigkeit **Definition:** The tendency to change one’s mood, attitude, or behavior unpredictably and frequently, often without a clear reason. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Launenhaftigkeit*. Usually used in the singular. Related adjective: *launenhaft* (“moody / capricious”). **Example:** *Seine Launenhaftigkeit machte die Zusammenarbeit schwierig.* — “His moodiness made working together difficult.” **English:** moodiness / capriciousness / fickleness · **French:** humeur changeante / inconstance / caprice

sich auflehnen

Synonym: rebellieren / sich widersetzen / Widerstand leisten **Definition:** To resist, rebel against, or openly oppose a person, authority, rule, or situation that one does not accept. **Grammar:** Reflexive, separable verb: *sich auflehnen* – *lehnte sich auf* – *hat sich aufgelehnt*. Common construction: *sich gegen jemanden/etwas auflehnen*. **Example:** *Die Bevölkerung lehnte sich gegen die ungerechte Herrschaft auf.* — “The population rebelled against the unjust rule.” **English:** rebel / resist / rise up against · **French:** se rebeller / se dresser contre / résister à

leiden

Synonym: erdulden / ertragen / Schmerzen haben **Definition:** To suffer physically or emotionally, or to be affected by an illness, problem, or difficult condition. It can also mean to tolerate or endure something, especially in the expression *etwas nicht leiden können*. **Grammar:** Strong verb: *leiden* – *litt* – *hat gelitten*. Common constructions: *an etwas leiden* (“to suffer from something”), *unter etwas leiden* (“to suffer because of something”), and *jemanden/etwas nicht leiden können* (“to dislike someone/something”). **Example:** *Viele Menschen leiden unter ständigem Stress.* — “Many people suffer from constant stress.” **English:** suffer / endure · **French:** souffrir / endurer

sich gezwungen fühlen

Synonym: sich verpflichtet fühlen / keine andere Wahl sehen / sich genötigt fühlen **Definition:** To feel that one has no real choice but to do something because of pressure, circumstances, duty, or expectations. **Grammar:** Reflexive construction with *sich fühlen*: *sich gezwungen fühlen*, *etwas zu tun*. The infinitive clause normally uses *zu*: *Ich fühle mich gezwungen, zu reagieren*. **Example:** *Sie fühlte sich gezwungen, ihre Entscheidung zu erklären.* — “She felt compelled to explain her decision.” **English:** feel compelled / feel forced / feel obliged · **French:** se sentir obligé / contraint

der Wandel

Synonym: Veränderung / Entwicklung / Umbruch **Definition:** A process of change or transformation, especially one that happens over time in society, culture, politics, technology, attitudes, or personal circumstances. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Wandel*. Usually used in the singular. Common expressions include *gesellschaftlicher Wandel*, *politischer Wandel*, *im Wandel sein*, and *einen Wandel vollziehen*. **Example:** *Die Gesellschaft befindet sich in einem tiefgreifenden Wandel.* — “Society is undergoing a profound change.” **English:** change / transformation / shift · **French:** changement / transformation / évolution

unangemessen

Synonym: unpassend / unangebracht / nicht angemessen **Definition:** Not appropriate, suitable, or proper for a particular situation, context, standard, or expectation. It can describe behavior, language, clothing, reactions, prices, or decisions. **Grammar:** Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Das ist unangemessen*) or attributively (*ein unangemessenes Verhalten*). **Example:** *Seine Bemerkung war in dieser Situation völlig unangemessen.* — “His remark was completely inappropriate in that situation.” **English:** inappropriate / unsuitable / improper · **French:** inapproprié / déplacé / inadéquat

verhüllen

Synonym: bedecken / verbergen / verschleiern **Definition:** To cover or conceal someone or something so that it cannot be clearly seen. Figuratively, it can also mean to obscure or disguise the true nature of something. **Grammar:** Weak, inseparable verb: *verhüllen* – *verhüllte* – *hat verhüllt*. Usually takes an accusative object: *jemanden/etwas verhüllen*. **Example:** *Dichter Nebel verhüllte die Berge.* — “Thick fog concealed the mountains.” **English:** cover / conceal / veil / obscure · **French:** voiler / couvrir / dissimuler

der Schaden

Synonym: Beschädigung / Verlust / Nachteil **Definition:** Harm, damage, or loss caused to a person, object, organization, environment, or situation. It can refer to physical damage, financial loss, or more abstract harm. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: *der Schaden*; plural: *die Schäden*. Common expressions include *Schaden verursachen*, *Schaden nehmen*, *jemandem Schaden zufügen*, and *einen Schaden beheben*. **Example:** *Der Sturm verursachte erhebliche Schäden an den Gebäuden.* — “The storm caused considerable damage to the buildings.” **English:** damage / harm / loss · **French:** dommage / dégât / préjudice

das Begehren

Synonym: Verlangen / Wunsch / Forderung **Definition:** A strong desire, wish, or demand for something. Depending on context, it can sound formal, legal, literary, or somewhat elevated. In legal language, it may refer to a claim or request. **Grammar:** Neuter noun: *das Begehren*; plural: *die Begehren* is possible but uncommon. Related verb: *begehren* (“to desire / demand”). **Example:** *Sein Begehren nach Macht wurde immer stärker.* — “His desire for power became stronger and stronger.” **English:** desire / demand / claim · **French:** désir / demande / revendication

das Zelt

Synonym: Unterkunft / Campingzelt **Definition:** A portable shelter made of fabric or similar material stretched over poles or a frame, commonly used for camping or temporary accommodation. **Grammar:** Neuter noun: **das Zelt**; plural: **die Zelte**. **Example:** *Die Soldaten schlugen ihre Zelte am Fluss auf.* — “The soldiers pitched their tents by the river.” **English:** tent · **French:** tente

der Kessel

Synonym: Behälter / Kochkessel **Definition:** A large container, traditionally made of metal, used for heating or boiling liquids. In military language, **Kessel** can also mean an area in which troops are completely surrounded by enemy forces. **Grammar:** Masculine noun: **der Kessel**; plural: **die Kessel**. **Example:** *Die Armee geriet in einen Kessel und konnte sich kaum zurückziehen.* — “The army became encircled and could barely retreat.” **English:** kettle / cauldron; encirclement (military) · **French:** chaudron / encerclement

zwingen

Synonym: nötigen / unter Druck setzen / dazu bringen **Definition:** To force or compel someone to do something against their preference or because they have no real alternative. It can refer to physical force, pressure, circumstances, rules, or necessity. **Grammar:** Strong verb: *zwingen* – *zwang* – *hat gezwungen*. Common construction: *jemanden zu etwas zwingen* or *jemanden zwingen, etwas zu tun*. The person being forced is in the accusative. Related expression: *sich gezwungen fühlen, etwas zu tun* (“to feel compelled to

do something"). **Example:** *Die Umstände zwangen ihn, seine Pläne zu ändern.* — "The circumstances forced him to change his plans." **English:** force / compel · **French:** forcer / contraindre

die Gewalt

Synonym: Gewalttätigkeit / Zwang / Macht depending on context

Definition: The use of physical force, coercion, or power to harm, control, or intimidate someone. Depending on context, *Gewalt* can also mean authority or institutional power, as in *Staatsgewalt*.

Grammar: Feminine noun: *die Gewalt*. Usually used in the singular. Common expressions include *Gewalt anwenden* ("to use violence"), *Gewalt ausüben* ("to exercise violence/force"), *unter Gewalt leiden* ("to suffer from violence"), and *jede Form von Gewalt* ("every form of violence"). In your file, it appears in *Sie verabscheut jede Form von Gewalt*.

Example: *Gewalt ist keine Lösung für politische Konflikte.* — "Violence is not a solution to political conflicts."

English: violence / force / power · **French:** violence / force / pouvoir

bewahren

Synonym: erhalten / schützen / aufrechterhalten

Definition: To keep, preserve, protect, or maintain something so that it is not lost, destroyed, changed, or forgotten. It is often used with things such as peace, traditions, memories, secrets, composure, or one's dignity.

Grammar: Weak, inseparable verb: *bewahren* – *bewahrte* – *hat bewahrt*. Usually takes an accusative object: *etwas bewahren*. A very common construction is *jemanden/etwas vor etwas bewahren* ("to protect/save someone or something from something"), where *vor* takes the dative.

Example: *Auch in schwierigen Situationen bewahrte sie ihre Ruhe.* — "Even in difficult situations, she kept her composure."

English: preserve / keep / maintain / protect · **French:** préserver / conserver / garder

hereinbrechen / über jemanden hereinbrechen

Synonym: plötzlich eintreten / jemanden unerwartet treffen / über jemanden kommen

Definition: To happen suddenly and forcefully, especially when referring to something difficult, dangerous, or unpleasant that affects someone unexpectedly. In the expression *über jemanden hereinbrechen*, the event is pictured as if it were crashing down upon the person.

Grammar: Strong, separable verb: *hereinbrechen* – *brach herein* – *ist hereingebrochen*. Common construction: *etwas bricht über jemanden herein*. The thing that happens is the subject, while *über* takes the accusative: *über uns*, *über ihn*, *über die Stadt*.

Example: *Was auch über uns hereinbrechen mag, wir werden zusammenhalten.* — "Whatever may befall us, we will stick together."

In your phrase, **Was auch über uns hereinbrechen mag**, *mag* is part of a concessive construction meaning roughly **“whatever may...”**. So the whole phrase means: **“Whatever may befall us” / “Whatever may come crashing down on us.”**

English: befall / descend upon / strike suddenly · **French:** s’abattre sur / fondre sur

der Sog

Synonym: Zug / Anziehungskraft / Strömung

Definition: A pulling force that draws something toward or into something else. Literally, it can describe suction or a strong current in water or air. Figuratively, it often means a powerful attraction or influence that pulls someone into a situation, mood, movement, or development.

Grammar: Masculine noun: *der Sog*; plural: *die Sogwirkungen* is more common than a simple plural in many contexts, though *die Soge* is possible but rare. Common expressions include *in den Sog geraten* (“to get drawn into something”) and *jemanden in seinen Sog ziehen* (“to draw someone in”).

Example: *Die Ereignisse zogen immer mehr Menschen in ihren Sog.* — “The events drew more and more people in.”

English: pull / suction / undertow / draw · **French:** aspiration / attraction / courant d’entraînement

zuversichtlich

Synonym: optimistisch / hoffnungsvoll / guter Dinge

Definition: Feeling confident and optimistic that something will develop positively or that a desired result will be achieved. It expresses trust in a favorable future outcome.

Grammar: Adjective. It can be used predicatively (*Ich bin zuversichtlich*) or declined before a noun (*eine zuversichtliche Haltung*). A common construction is **zuversichtlich sein, dass**

Example: *Ich bin zuversichtlich, dass wir eine Lösung finden werden.* — “I am confident that we will find a solution.”

English: confident / optimistic / hopeful · **French:** confiant / optimiste

jemanden widrigen Umständen aussetzen

Synonym: jemanden schwierigen Bedingungen ausliefern / jemanden ungünstigen Bedingungen

aussetzen Definition: To cause or allow someone to experience difficult, unfavorable, or adverse conditions, often without sufficient protection from them. **Grammar:** Fixed construction: **jemanden etwas aussetzen**. The person is in the **accusative** (*jemanden*), while the thing or condition is in the **dative** (*widrigen Umständen*). Verb: *aussetzen* – *setzte aus* – *hat ausgesetzt*. **Example:** *Man sollte Kinder nicht unnötig widrigen Umständen aussetzen.* — “Children should not be unnecessarily exposed to adverse conditions.” **English:** expose someone to adverse conditions · **French:** exposer quelqu’un à des conditions défavorables

überwältigt (überwältigend)

Synonym: überfordert / tief bewegt / überwunden depending on context **Definition:** Strongly affected by an emotion, impression, amount of work, or situation to the point that it becomes difficult to process or handle. It can be positive or negative. **Grammar:** Past participle of *überwältigen*, often used adjectivally. Verb: *überwältigen* – *überwältigte* – *hat überwältigt*. Common construction: *von etwas überwältigt sein*. **Example:** *Sie war von der Unterstützung ihrer Freunde überwältigt.* — “She was overwhelmed by the support of her friends.” **English:** overwhelmed / overcome · **French:** submergé / bouleversé / dépassé

die Bergung

Synonym: Rettung / Sicherung / Hebung depending on context **Definition:** The act of recovering, rescuing, or retrieving people, vehicles, objects, or remains from a difficult, dangerous, or inaccessible place. It is often used in rescue, accident, maritime, and recovery contexts. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Bergung*, plural: *die Bergungen*. Related verb: *bergen* – *barg* – *hat geborgen*. **Example:** *Die Bergung des Fahrzeugs dauerte mehrere Stunden.* — “The recovery of the vehicle took several hours.” **English:** recovery / rescue / retrieval / salvage · **French:** récupération / sauvetage / dégagement

die Spannung / die Spannungen

Synonym: Anspannung / Konflikt / Belastung / elektrische Spannung depending on context **Definition:** A state of pressure, strain, or conflict between people, groups, countries, or competing interests. It can also refer to suspense or anticipation, physical tension, or electrical voltage. **Grammar:** Feminine noun: *die Spannung*, plural: *die Spannungen*. In political or social contexts, the plural is very common: *politische Spannungen*, *soziale Spannungen*, *zunehmende Spannungen*. **Example:** *Die Spannungen zwischen den beiden Ländern nahmen weiter zu.* — “Tensions between the two countries continued to increase.” **English:** tension / tensions / suspense / voltage · **French:** tension / tensions In the quiz sentence, „angesichts der zunehmenden Spannungen“ means “in view of the growing tensions.”

die Heftigkeit

Synonym: Intensität / Stärke / Wucht / Vehemenz

Definition: A high degree of strength, force, or intensity. It can describe emotions, reactions, arguments, attacks, weather, pain, or other events that occur with unusual power or violence.

Grammar: Feminine noun: *die Heftigkeit*. Usually used in the singular. Related adjective: *heftig* (“intense / violent / severe”). Common expressions include *mit großer Heftigkeit*, *die Heftigkeit einer Reaktion* and *an Heftigkeit zunehmen*.

Example: *Die Heftigkeit seiner Reaktion überraschte alle Anwesenden.* — “The intensity of his reaction surprised everyone present.”

English: intensity / severity / force / vehemence · **French:** intensité / violence / véhémence

A useful distinction: **Stärke** is very general, while **Heftigkeit** usually implies something **forceful, intense, sudden, or emotionally charged**.

verwurzelt

Wahrscheinlich meinst du **verwurzelt**.

Synonym: fest verankert / tief verbunden / tief verankert

Definition: Literally, having roots in the ground. Figuratively, it means being deeply connected to a place, culture, tradition, belief, or way of thinking.

Grammar: Past participle of *verwurzeln*, often used adjectivally. Verb: *verwurzeln* – *verwurzelte* – *hat verwurzelt*. Very common construction: **in etwas verwurzelt sein**.

Example: *Diese Tradition ist tief in der regionalen Kultur verwurzelt.* — “This tradition is deeply rooted in the regional culture.”

English: rooted / deeply rooted / firmly established · French: enraciné / profondément ancré

Wahrscheinlich meinst du **überwinden** oder **überwunden**.

überwinden

Synonym: bezwingen / bewältigen / besiegen / hinter sich lassen

Definition: To successfully deal with, conquer, or get past a difficulty, fear, obstacle, weakness, or opponent.

Grammar: Strong verb: *überwinden* – *überwand* – *hat überwunden*. Usually takes an **accusative object**: *eine Angst überwinden*, *ein Hindernis überwinden*.

Example: *Sie konnte ihre Angst schließlich überwinden.* — “She was eventually able to overcome her fear.”

English: overcome / conquer / surmount · French: surmonter / vaincre

überwunden = past participle: *Er hat seine Angst überwunden*.

If you meant a Konjunktiv-II form, it would be **überwänden**, not *überwünden*.

anfällig

Synonym: empfindlich / verwundbar / empfänglich

Definition: Easily affected, harmed, influenced, or likely to develop a particular problem, illness, weakness, or reaction.

Grammar: Adjective. Very common constructions are **anfällig für + Akkusativ** and **gegenüber etwas anfällig sein**.

Example: *Ältere Menschen sind oft anfälliger für Infektionen.* — “Older people are often more susceptible to infections.”

English: susceptible / vulnerable / prone · French: sensible / vulnérable / sujet à

Useful nuance: **anfällig für** usually means “prone/susceptible to,” while **verwundbar** is more directly “vulnerable” in the sense of being open to harm or attack.

angewiesen

Synonym: abhängig / auf etwas angewiesen sein / etwas benötigen

Definition: Dependent on or reliant on someone or something because it is necessary for you. Often implies that you cannot manage properly without it.

Grammar: Usually used in the construction **auf jemanden/etwas angewiesen sein**. **auf** takes the **accusative** here.

Example: *Viele ältere Menschen sind im Alltag auf Unterstützung angewiesen.* — “Many elderly people depend on assistance in everyday life.”

English: dependent on / reliant on / in need of · **French:** dépendant de / tributaire de

Common pattern: *Ich bin auf deine Hilfe angewiesen.* = “I depend on / need your help.”

CEFR: roughly **B2**; the construction **auf etwas angewiesen sein** is particularly useful at B2–C1.